

Babar Khan

Houston, TX (Open to Remote / Dubai Relocation)

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AI Strategy | Product Innovation | Business Growth

Entrepreneurial leader with 15+ years of global experience building AI-powered platforms and transforming operations across EdTech, SaaS, and enterprise services. MBA from Rice University with proven success in product strategy, go-to-market execution, and cross-functional leadership. Spearheaded 3 major ventures—including an AI SaaS Bot builder, an upskilling edtech platform, and a smart retail marketplace—under tight resource constraints. Seeking to bring this executional rigor to AI-forward teams scaling purpose-driven solutions.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI-Driven Product Management | Go-to-Market Strategy | EdTech & LMS Systems
AI Integration | Business Operations | Global Consulting | Digital Transformation
Cross-Functional Leadership | Revenue Growth | Pitch Decks | Strategic Partnerships

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Nextgen Information Services (Houston, TX)

Head of Product Strategy and Growth | Apr 2020 – Present

Built and led multiple tech ventures for the CEO of a U.S. IT firm and staffing company, reporting directly to the founder.

Botafy – No-code AI Bot Builder

- Co-founded Botafy, an AI SaaS platform to build assistant bots trained on custom files and prompts.
- Conducted competitive mapping and use-case verticalization to differentiate in crowded AI space.
- Secured 6+ pilot clients pre-launch via strategic B2B outreach and vertical use-case decks.
- Developed positioning for integrations into CRMs, LMS, and internal knowledge bases.

SkillBridge – AI-powered EdTech Platform

- Built a Duolingo-style career upskilling product simulating job experiences with “SkillCo.”
- Led product development across India and U.S. teams using LMS (Moodle) + AI content pipelines.
- Pitched to 20+ non-profits, schools, and workforce boards for partnerships and funding pilots.
- Defined and executed end-to-end GTM strategies; developed pitch decks for VCs and accelerators.
- Reduced marketing ops spending by 10% via CRM automation and improved user acquisition funnels.

- Hired and trained cross-functional teams (designers, devs, marketers) across U.S. and India.
- Drove strategic shift from bootstrapped experimentation to a focused AI consulting services arm.

OYO USA (Houston, TX)

Head of Business Development – South Texas | Oct 2019 – Apr 2020

- Managed a 7-member sales team; delivered 260% of the target within 6 months.
- Successfully onboarded and launched 2 properties during early COVID disruptions.

EMGAGE USA (Houston, TX)

Strategy Associate (Intern) | Jun 2018 – Aug 2018

- Developed a 5-year digital engagement roadmap, increasing membership by 18%.

Embratel (Sao Paulo, Brazil)

Strategy Consultant | Apr 2018 – May 2018

Designed a scalable cloud GTM strategy for a \$100M hyperscale initiative.

QAS Arabia (Saudi Arabia)

Business Development & Product Manager | 2015 – 2017

- Developed two high-performing product lines for Oil & Gas sector; doubled sales in Year 1.
- Cut procurement costs by 13% through vendor restructuring and new global partnerships.

Zamil Group (Saudi Arabia)

Progression: Sales Engineer → Sr. Sales → BD Associate → Project Manager | 2009 – 2015

- Launched Zamil's Passive Fire Protection unit; landed 20% of annual revenue in contracts.
- Managed delivery of \$15M+ worth of fireproofing projects with 95%+ client satisfaction.
- Led 30+ personnel across sales, QA, procurement, and delivery teams.

EDUCATION

MBA – Strategy, Marketing & Blockchain

Rice University, Jones Graduate School of Business | Houston, TX

GMAT 750 | 90% Jones Scholarship | Top 5% Citizen Award

Blockchain Officer | Communication Fellow | Leadership Coach (2020 team ranked 2nd of 36)

B.S. Computer Science & Engineering

Memorial University, Canada / Al-Ghurair University, Dubai

Internships: Samsung (UAE), Zamil Group (KSA), BLI (Canada)

CERTIFICATIONS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

IBM Quantum Computing | Coursera AI/ML Certificates (in progress)

Tools: Python, Tableau, HubSpot, Salesforce, Celonis, SQL, Shopify

Agile Project Leadership | Strategic AI Integration | AI Product Taxonomy & Pricing

GLOBAL EXPOSURE & LEADERSHIP

- Led teams across U.S., India, Brazil, Canada, and Saudi Arabia
- Toastmasters President – Chartering 10+ corporate clubs across the Middle East
- Climbed Kilimanjaro (19,000+ ft) and Parvati Pass (17,000 ft); summit leadership and resilience
- Red Cross Volunteer for Hurricane Harvey relief; advised 100+ MBA peers as a Rice fellow